

ZHASSULAN SERIKULY

Senior Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 6+ years of commercial experience architecting, scaling, and delivering 100+ high-performance applications and data-intensive platforms across enterprise software, fintech, e-commerce, and digital-twin platforms, serving 1M+ users. Proven track record of technical leadership, mentoring teams of up to 18 engineers, and full SDLC ownership. Deep expertise across the full stack — React, Next.js, and TypeScript on the frontend, Node.js, NestJS, PostgreSQL, and MongoDB on the backend. Integrated AI-assisted development workflows with Cursor, Claude Code, and GitHub Copilot, automating quality gates and repetitive engineering tasks to cut time-to-market by ~2x.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Designed a multi-layer caching and invalidation strategy across **10+ platforms**, cutting redundant **API traffic by 50%** and reducing cloud infrastructure **costs by an estimated 20%**.
- Created shared frontend engineering standards** for code reviews and component architecture, **adopted across 2 companies and 100+ production projects**, shortening onboarding for new engineers by 40%.

EXPERIENCE

CIKLUM — Senior Software Engineer | *Bucharest, Romania (Remote)* | Aug 2025 – Sep 2026

UK-based digital product and enterprise software engineering company.

- Architecture:** Designed React/Next.js and NestJS architecture across 10+ modules, building shared UI components with strict TypeScript and WCAG AA compliance and type-safe REST/GraphQL APIs, cutting feature implementation time by ~30%.
- Frontend Modernization:** Migrated React/Next.js from Pages Router to App Router with Server Components and JavaScript to strict TypeScript; introduced FSD and TanStack Query to standardize architecture and reduce duplicated data fetching.
- Web Performance:** Profiled and optimized rendering, hydration, and interaction-heavy flows across high-traffic modules serving 1–3M users, reducing Interaction to Next Paint (INP) from ~280ms to ~150ms.
- Technical Leadership & Reliability:** Drove frontend architecture and planning for 6 engineers, reviewing ~15 GitLab MRs/week and helping reduce post-merge defects by 35%; expanded automated testing with CI/CD quality gates and Sentry monitoring.
- AI Integration & Tooling:** Built LLM-powered product features using RAG with NestJS backend services; also integrated Cursor, Claude Code, and GitHub Copilot into engineering workflows, cutting repeatable task time by nearly half.

KEYHORSE — Middle → Senior → Team Lead Software Engineer | *Almaty, Kazakhstan* | Jul 2021 – Aug 2025

GIS and digital-twin platform company serving Central Asia

- Engineering Leadership:** Led 18 engineers across 3 teams, setting technical direction for 80+ large-scale regional GIS platforms and 100+ smaller digital-twin deployments serving 1.5M+ users across 4 countries.
- Delivery & Process:** Independently architected and launched 10 enterprise platforms in 1–1.5 months each (~2x faster); introduced Scrum, shared planning, estimation, code review, and documentation practices, cutting onboarding by 40%.
- Frontend & GIS:** Built a shared React architecture using FSD with 100+ reusable Storybook components; optimized Mapbox GL JS and Elasticsearch across 500K+ geo-objects, cutting render time from 800ms to 480ms and search latency by 30%.
- Backend & Systems:** Built 35+ Node.js/NestJS REST APIs with PostgreSQL, MongoDB, and Redis, containerized with Docker; generated OpenAPI clients and moved GIS processing to Kafka workers with retries, idempotency, and WebSocket updates.
- Quality & Observability:** Set up shared testing with Vitest, Playwright, and Cypress across 86 repositories, with automated checks through GitLab CI/CD. Used Grafana dashboards and alerts to monitor production after deployment.

Earlier Experience

- Independent Contractor — Freelance Engineer (2019–2025, alongside full-time roles)** — Delivered 40+ React/Angular/Vue and Node.js apps for international SaaS and e-commerce clients, integrating third-party APIs and owning the full SDLC.
- DAR (Technology group building digital products) — Software Engineer (Jun 2020 – Jul 2021)** — Delivered ~20 React/Vue web and 5–7 mobile apps (Ionic, React Native) across 3–4 parallel projects; shipped food-delivery/booking platforms solo (~200 restaurants, 1,000+ listings) in ~1 month each; cut load times by up to 40%; built FastAPI/MySQL backends for 6 apps.
- EPAM Systems — Software Engineer Intern (Jan 2020 – Jun 2020)** — Built React/TypeScript features across 5+ applications, resolved production issues, wrote tests, and participated in code reviews; selected as 1 of 3 engineers from 40+ candidates.

SKILLS

Frontend: React, Next.js, Angular, Vue, Nuxt.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, Redux, Pinia, Zustand, TanStack Query, FSD, Tailwind, SCSS
Backend & APIs: Node.js, NestJS, Express, FastAPI, Python, REST APIs, GraphQL, WebSockets, Microservices, DDD, RBAC
Data & Cloud: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS, Azure, GCP, Terraform
Testing & DevOps: Jest/Vitest, Cypress/Playwright, CI/CD, Git, Docker, Kubernetes, Azure DevOps, Webpack/Vite, Grafana, Sentry
AI, Mobile & Quality: LLMs, AI-Assisted Development, React Native, Ionic, Capacitor, Core Web Vitals, WCAG, Agile/Scrum, SDLC

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

Education: B.Sc. in Information Systems | Suleyman Demirel University (SDU), 2022

Certifications: [IELTS Academic 7.0 \(C1 Equivalent, 2023\)](#) | [Professional Recommendation Letter Available](#)

Languages: English (Full Professional) | Kazakh, Russian (Native) | Turkish (Professional Working/B2) | [Chinese \(Elementary/A2\)](#)